

THE SOCIAL UNIVERSE (TSU)

Continuity Bible — Master Canon Document

Purpose: This is the single source of truth for TSU canon. Every writer, every script, every "wait, did we already establish X" question gets answered here first. If it's not in this doc, it's not canon yet — propose it, don't assume it. This doc is the Kevin Feige's-office equivalent: nothing ships to a script until it's logged here.

Companion docs: TSU_Platform_Roster.md (fictional platforms) · TSU_Core_Cast.md (founding character bios)

1. THE SERIALIZATION MODEL

Ratio: 70% standalone / 30% serialized, matching the proven MCU structure.

- **The 70%:** Every platform-founding film must work as a complete, self-contained story for an audience who has seen *nothing* else in TSU. No film's core plot may depend on information withheld to a prior film.
 - **The 30%:** Reserved for recurring characters crossing platforms, the through-line antagonist forces (THE ENGINE, THE SWARM, THE LEAK, THE COPIES), fixed timeline anchor-events referenced across films, and stingers/easter eggs seeding future Phases.
 - **Rule of thumb for any new scene:** if removing it would make a *different* film confusing, it's part of the 30% and must be logged in this doc's Cross-Film Threads section before the film locks picture. If removing it only affects the film it's in, it's part of the 70% and doesn't need cross-checking.
-

2. FORMAT & HOUSE STYLE

Binding specs for every TSU script. A script that deviates from these numbers needs a sign-off logged in §8, same as any other locked fact.

Genre & Subgenre

Primary genre: **Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story** — the spine of the whole universe, playing the same structural role "superhero action" plays for the MCU. This is what "100% faithful to source material" actually means in practice: dramatizing real founding myths (fictionalized), not inventing fantasy.

Subgenres layer per-Phase, the way MCU shifts tone film to film, rather than applying uniformly to every entry: - **Corporate thriller** — founder disputes, betrayals, acquisitions (THE ROSTER's origin, the Phase 2 "Quiet Acquisition") - **Underdog sports-movie structure** — borrowed shape (not genre) for Phase 1 founding arcs: scrappy outsider builds something from nothing, takes on giants - **Ensemble dramedy** — the found-family/relationship material (weddings, godparent-hood, group dynamics) that can't live inside corporate-thriller tension alone - **Satire, dialed carefully** — reserved specifically for THE SWARM and

THE ENGINE storylines; TSU's comic-relief valve, same job Ant-Man/Guardians plays tonally inside a heavier universe - **Legal/courtroom drama** — recurring beat for THE LEAK scandals and founder-dispute litigation, same way MCU periodically drops into "Congressional hearing" mode

Rating

PG-13 across the entire universe. No exceptions, no R-rated entries, no PG entries. This is a commercial mechanism, not just a tone choice — PG-13 is the only rating that plays to teens, parents, and adults simultaneously, which is the actual revenue engine of a tentpole franchise. It's also the only rating built to handle betrayal, addiction-adjacent tech-culture critique, and corporate ruthlessness honestly without capping the audience or killing merchandising.

Runtime

Entry Type	Runtime
Standard platform-origin film	130–150 minutes
Phase finale / ensemble crossover	150–180 minutes

Script Page Count (*Industry standard: 1 page is about 1 minute of screen time*)

Entry Type	Page Count
Standard platform-origin film	120–140 pages
Phase finale / ensemble crossover	150–170 pages (hard ceiling — scripts that balloon past this cut in the edit anyway; write tight rather than shoot pages you'll lose)

Act Structure

Three acts, always. - **Act I** — ~25% of runtime (~30–35 pages): ordinary world, inciting incident (the spark for the platform), ends on the decision to build it - **Act II** — ~50% (~65–75 pages): the build, the complications, relationship strain, midpoint escalation (usually a rival platform or a betrayal), ends on the low point / all-is-lost beat - **Act III** — ~25% (~30–35 pages): climax (usually the platform's public launch or direct confrontation with a rival/villain force), resolution, stinger

Scene Count

Entry Type	Scene Count
Standard platform-origin film	~40–55 scenes
Phase finale / ensemble crossover	~55–70 scenes (larger ensemble needs more coverage)

3. FIXED TIMELINE ANCHORS

Dates and events every film must treat as immovable fact. Individual films may show these events from a new angle but may never contradict them.

Anchor Event	Date	What It Locks
THE LEDGER founded	1997	Phase 0 opens
HOMESTEAD shutdown ("The First Erasure")	2001	TSU's first mass-casualty event — referenced as cultural trauma in later Phases
THE FIRST CIRCLE launches	2002	Phase 1 begins
TOP8 launches	2003	—
THE BOARDROOM launches	2003	—
THE ROSTER launches	Feb 2004	Founding-four complete
Phase 1 Finale — "The Feed War"	2004–2005	THE ROSTER absorbs/outlasts TOP8. First platform-vs-platform casualty event. Opening act dramatized in <code>scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md</code> ; TOP8's full wind-down happens off-screen in the intervening years, referenced (not dramatized) in <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code> .
THE PROJECTOR launches	2005	Phase 2 begins
THE HIVE launches	2005	—
THE WIRE launches	2006	—
THE GALLERY launches	2007	—
THE FRAME launches	2010	Phase 2 closes

Anchor Event	Date	What It Locks
Phase 2 Finale — "The Quiet Acquisition"	2010–2012	THE ROSTER acquires THE FRAME. Dramatized in <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code> (2011) as a fair deal on Arianna Cummings's own terms — the anchor is honored corporately, reframed emotionally as redemption for Film 1's freeze-out rather than a repeat of it.
THE WHISPER NETWORK launches	2009	Phase 3 begins (chronological overlap w/ Phase 2 is intentional — see §5)
THE ATLAS launches	2010	—
THE EMBER launches	2011	—
THE FLICKER launches	2013	—
"The Flicker Goes Dark"	2016	THE FLICKER shuts down. TSU's mass-mourning event. Diaspora subplot begins.
THE OUTPOST launches	2015	Phase 3 closes
THE ORACLE launches	2018	Phase 4 begins
THE MIRROR launches	2020	—
THE ECHO launches	2023	—
SIGNAL-0 (THE WIRE reborn)	2023	Phase 4 current state

Standing rule: no future script may move a launch date without a change-request logged in §8 and approved before the page is written. A launch date is load-bearing — other films' timelines are built off it.

4. CHARACTER LOCATION / STATUS TRACKER

Where each founding cast member is, professionally, at the start and end of each Phase. Update this table the moment any film changes a character's status — this is the most common source of continuity errors in ensemble franchises (an actor's film shoots out of release order, and a character's status quo gets contradicted by accident).

Character	Status, Start of Phase 1 (2002)	Status, End of Phase 1 (2004–05)	Notes
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Working actor/singer, pre-adult-breakout	Founder/CEO, THE ROSTER; survived the Feed War's opening attack, a managed arrhythmia, and a public reckoning with Solomon Kane's claim against Victor Donohue	Locked per scripts/THE_ROSTER.md and scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md. Public triumph, personal cost — closes Phase 1 estranged from Amond, leaning on Esther and Tyrese instead
Amond Baker	Typecast, cooling career	Co-founder, THE ROSTER — diluted out via cap-table restructure; estranged from Marc-Anthony	Locked per scripts/THE_ROSTER.md. This wound is the direct inciting wound for his own founding story, Film 2/Phase 2 (see §9)
Tyrese Avery	Established global pop superstar	Founder, THE PROJECTOR (launched, then lost, then rebuilt smaller in Dec 2005)	Locked per scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md. New relationship (Dr. Simone Kester) originates here — first romantic arc for this character
Esther Smilley	Award-winning actress, fighting "sweetheart" typecasting	<i>(platform assignment pending)</i>	Not yet romantically involved w/ Marc-Anthony — that doesn't begin until 2011, no film may imply earlier
Arianna Cummings	Three professional near-misses, no breakthrough	Founder, THE FRAME (launched Oct 25, 2010, from a hospital waiting room during her brother's recovery)	Locked per scripts/THE_FRAME.md. New relationship (Malcolm Pierce) originates here
Harmony Divine	Dancer transitioning to acting	<i>(platform assignment pending)</i>	Not yet romantically involved w/ Amond — begins 2013
Tyler Chapman	Steady "and also starring" work, capped ceiling	<i>(platform assignment pending)</i>	Secret music ambition is a Chekhov's gun — a later Phase should pay it off

Locked romantic timeline (do not contradict in any script, flashback, or flash-forward): - Marc-Anthony & Esther: friends throughout Phase 1–2, together 2011, married June 2013 (dramatized in scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md) - Amond & Harmony: circling throughout Phase 1–3, together June

2013 at the above wedding (dramatized in [scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md](#)), married 2015 - Emma & Victoria Bullock born May 10, 2012 (twins) - Lyric Baker born April 20, 2014; Marc-Anthony is godfather

Status after Film 6 ([scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md](#), closing Nov 2011) — a second checkpoint, since the table above only tracks through in-universe Phase 1 (2004–05) and the release-slot slate runs well past that:

Character	Status, end of THE ASSEMBLY (2011)
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Founder/CEO, THE ROSTER; refused a hostile acquisition of THE FRAME and negotiated a fair one instead; reconciling with Amond, not yet fully; together with Esther as of this film, per the locked date
Amond Baker	Founder/CEO, THE WIRE; the one who spotted Teddy's pattern first and warned Arianna; reconciling with Marc-Anthony, not yet fully — deliberately unresolved
Tyrese Avery	Founder, THE PROJECTOR, now fully stable under Jamal Kester's product leadership; with Dr. Simone Kester
Esther Smiley	Effectively running much of THE ROSTER's day-to-day operations; together with Marc-Anthony as of this film
Arianna Cummings	THE FRAME acquired by THE ROSTER on her own terms — full creative control retained, her name still on the door; with Malcolm Pierce
Harmony Divine	Still circling Amond, deliberately unresolved per the locked 2013 date
Tyler Chapman	Unassigned, unresolved — secret music ambition still an open Chekhov's gun for a future Phase

Status after Film 7 ([scripts/THE_ROSTER_3.md](#), closing May 10, 2012):

Character	Status, end of THE ROSTER 3 (May 2012)
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Chairman and CEO, THE ROSTER — unchanged, not up for negotiation in this film; arrhythmia finally under real treatment; survived THE UNSEEN crisis by delegating rather than solving it alone; father to Emma and Victoria as of this film's final scene
Esther Smiley	Named President of THE ROSTER (day-to-day operations), formally, in this film's final scene — the role made official, not new, and not a change to Marc-Anthony's title; publicly dismantled Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist's synthetic-media operation herself; mother to Emma and Victoria

Character	Status, end of THE ROSTER 3 (May 2012)
Amond Baker	Founder/CEO, THE WIRE; caught Marc-Anthony's second collapse before anyone else did; reconciliation with Marc-Anthony now genuinely warm, if still imperfect
Tyrese Avery / Arianna Cummings	Both platforms' engineering teams co-built THE ROSTER's proof-of-origin countermeasure — the ensemble's first fully coordinated technical collaboration across companies
Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist	Exposed and in legal proceedings via Constance Abiodun-Mayhew; settlement includes public patent credit rather than just consulting fees

Status after Film 8 (scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md, closing Aug 2013):

Character	Status, end of THE PROJECTOR 2 (Aug 2013)
Tyrese Avery	Declined the Family-Safe Content Consortium chair; stays at THE PROJECTOR on his own terms; his mother Coralee Avery died July 2013 (see TSU_Family_Bible.md); new family-content guidelines launched in her memory
Marc-Anthony Bullock & Esther Smiley	Married June 2013 — the locked date, finally dramatized
Amond Baker & Harmony Divine	Together as of June 2013, at the above wedding — the locked date, finally dramatized; married 2015 still to come
Marcus Nguyen-Brandt	Genuinely helped Tyrese at real cost to his usual practice; quietly absorbed a significant, unacknowledged share of Vernon Price's collapsed operation in the process — a thread left open, not resolved
Vernon Price / Maxwell Sterling Asante	THE LULLABY exposed and collapsed; Maxwell already chasing the next pitch

Status after Film 9 (scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md, closing June 2014):

Character	Status, end of THE FRAME 2 (June 2014)
Arianna Cummings & Marc-Anthony Bullock	Co-exposed THE VERDICT and Evelyn Marchetti-Hale; first film where the two lead as genuine equals rather than one supporting the other

Character	Status, end of THE FRAME 2 (June 2014)
Priya Ramasubramanian	Alive the entire film — faked the severity of a near-fatal accident with Constance Abiodun-Mayhew's help to investigate Evelyn from hiding; revealed publicly at the climax; already tracking international regulatory names (Chioma Asante-Reyes) by the stinger
Evelyn Marchetti-Hale	Removed from every board she sat on; referred to Senator Ashworth-Okafor's committee
Benji Oyelaran-Cox	Not prosecuted; publicly credited for coming forward; cautiously welcomed back into the ensemble's orbit
All platforms Evelyn touched (THE ROSTER, THE FRAME, others)	Committed publicly to independent oversight and a real appeals process

5. THE VILLAINS BENCH — RULES OF ENGAGEMENT

Because THE ENGINE, THE LEAK, THE SWARM, and THE COPIES are forces rather than single actors/characters, they need usage rules so they don't become a crutch:

- **THE ENGINE** may appear inside any platform's internal story, but must manifest differently each time (it's not one villain wearing different masks — it's a recurring *idea*, re-cast in tone and visual language per platform). THE ENGINE inside THE ROSTER should not look or feel like THE ENGINE inside THE ORACLE.
- **THE LEAK** is a one-per-Phase maximum event. Overusing it flattens its impact — it should land like a real scandal, not a plot device you can pull twice a Phase.
- **THE SWARM** is the only bench villain allowed genuine comic relief — a trickster figure that should never be played as a pure threat.
- **THE COPIES** exist to signal a platform's decline is coming, never to be the actual reason a platform falls. The real cause of any platform's fall must always trace back to a character decision, per the "faithful to source material" mandate — these platforms died from human choices (acquisitions, mismanagement, neglect), not from an abstract force acting alone.

6. KNOWN TIMELINE OVERLAP (INTENTIONAL, NOT AN ERROR)

Phases are organized thematically, not strictly chronologically — same approach MCU uses (Captain Marvel is set in the 90s but released in Phase 3). THE WHISPER NETWORK (2009) launches before THE FRAME (2010) closes out Phase 2. This is intentional: Phase boundaries mark thematic shifts (Media Wars -> Mobile Saga), not hard calendar cutoffs. Any writer confused by an out-of-phase date should check this section before "fixing" it.

7. OPEN CONTINUITY QUESTIONS

(Must be resolved before Phase 1 scripts lock)

1. **Platform assignments** — which founder gets which platform. Nothing in §3 can be finalized until this is settled.

Locked constraint (user directive): the core seven are founders of the major platforms that are **still popular and around to this day** — i.e., surviving/thriving platforms as of present day, not defunct ones. This rules out assigning any of the core seven as founders of platforms already marked dead on the Platform Roster (THE LEDGER, ROLL CALL, DEAR DIARY, HOMESTEAD, THE FIRST CIRCLE, TOP8, THE FLICKER) — those stay populated by Rivals/Extended Ensemble characters instead. Which specific surviving platforms (candidates per the Roster: THE ROSTER, THE PROJECTOR, THE FRAME, THE HIVE, THE WIRE/SIGNAL-0, THE ORACLE, THE OUTPOST, THE WHISPER NETWORK, THE BOARDROOM, THE ATLAS, THE EMBER) map to which of the seven is **explicitly not decided yet** — do not assign in any script or scene until this is resolved and logged here.

Resolved so far: - **THE ROSTER** -> **Marc-Anthony Bullock** (founder) + **Amond Baker** (co-founder, diluted out). Locked per `scripts/THE_ROSTER.md`, Film 1 ("Iron Man" slot). - **THE WIRE** -> **Amond Baker** (sole founder, post-ROSTER). Locked as of this entry, Film 2 ("Incredible Hulk" slot) — see §9. Script not yet written. - **THE BOARDROOM** -> **no core-seven founder**. Per `scripts/THE_ROSTER.md` scene 13, it's already a mature "old guard" institution before Phase 1's story begins. It stays that way unless a future pass decides otherwise. - **THE PROJECTOR** -> **Tyrese Avery** (sole founder). Locked, Film 4 ("Thor" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md`. - **THE FRAME** -> **Arianna Cummings** (sole founder). Locked, Film 5 ("Captain America: The First Avenger" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_FRAME.md`. The reservation flagged when THE PROJECTOR was locked has now been claimed correctly, not spent on a different film. - Remaining unassigned: Esther Smiley, Harmony Divine, Tyler Chapman — and remaining unassigned surviving platforms: THE HIVE, THE ORACLE, THE OUTPOST, THE WHISPER NETWORK, THE ATLAS, THE EMBER. 2. Does Marc-Anthony's dynasty family (Natasha, Robert, Victor, Joan) have their own platform ties, or do they stay industry-only and never cross into TSU's tech side? 3. Is Tyrese's "outside perspective" going to culminate in him founding a platform himself (likely music/audio-coded, e.g. a Clubhouse-style entry in Phase 4), or does he stay permanently adjacent as a non-founder? 4. Does Tyler's music ambition get its own founding story later, or does it stay a personal subplot inside whichever platform story he's attached to? 5. Confirm whether the "lost a role to follower count" beat for Arianna is meant to happen at a specific, nameable point on the timeline (needs a year) so it can be logged as an anchor event.

8. CHANGE LOG

(Every edit to a locked fact gets logged here, with date and reason — never silently overwrite an established fact)

Date	Change	Reason
—	Doc created	Baseline canon established from Platform Roster + Core Cast docs
—	Added §2 Format & House Style (genre, rating, runtime, page count, act/scene structure); renumbered §3–§8	Locked universal format specs so all future scripts conform
2026-09-17	Added platform-assignment constraint to §7 Q1: the core seven must be founders of platforms still popular/surviving today, not defunct ones. Specific mapping still undecided.	User directive — narrows the open question without resolving it
2026-09-17	Locked Film 1 (THE ROSTER, Marc-Anthony + Amond) and Film 2 (THE WIRE, Amond solo) in §7 Q1 and new §9. Updated §4 tracker for Marc-Anthony and Amond accordingly. Confirmed THE BOARDROOM has no core-seven founder.	Script written for Film 1 (scripts/THE_ROSTER.md); Film 2 platform selected per user request, filling the "Incredible Hulk" release slot
2026-09-17	Standing rule added: a "what's the perfect platform" question is now always a cue to write the full script, not just select the platform. Locked Film 2's script (scripts/THE_WIRE.md).	User directive
2026-09-17	Locked Film 3: THE ROSTER 2 ("Iron Man 2" slot), dramatizing the Feed War's opening act. Added Eldridge Kane, Solomon Kane, and Carter Westbrook to TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md and TSU_Historical_Context.md §5. Updated §4 tracker for Marc-Anthony.	Script written per user request (scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md)
2026-09-18	Split the Donohue Estate from the Bullock Estate as separate residences; fixed three Victor's-study sluglines in scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md accordingly.	User correction

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 4: THE PROJECTOR ("Thor" slot), founded by Tyrese Avery. Added Jamal Kester and Dr. Simone Kester to <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code> . Flagged THE FRAME as reserved for the eventual "Captain America" slot rather than assigning it casually. Updated §4 tracker for Tyrese.	Script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md</code>)
2026-09-18	Locked Film 5: THE FRAME ("Captain America: The First Avenger" slot), founded by Arianna Cummings, claiming the reservation flagged in Film 4. Added Celeste Marlowe and Malcolm Pierce to <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code> ; activated Dr. Adaeze Okonkwo-Brennan and Delphine Okonkwo-Ash on-screen for the first time. Added Arianna's first locked relationship to <code>TSU_Core_Cast.md</code> . Updated §4 tracker for Arianna.	Script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_FRAME.md</code>)
2026-09-18	Locked Film 6: THE ASSEMBLY ("The Avengers" slot, Phase 1 Finale/Ensemble Crossover), closing the Film 1–6 release slate. No new core-seven platform assignment; dramatizes the Feed War's off-screen resolution and the Quiet Acquisition anchor. Added THE EVERYTHING to <code>TSU_Platform_Roster.md</code> Phase 3, resolving its "Open Slots to Discuss" Google+ note. Cashed in Teddy Ashcombe-Vance's full betrayal reveal and Yolanda Ferreira-Ashe's defection in <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code> . Added a post-Film-6 status checkpoint to §4 (the original table only tracks through in-universe Phase 1).	Script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code>)

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Disambiguated "Phase" into Release Phase (film slate groupings, e.g. "Films 1–6 are Release Phase 1") and Story Phase (§3's in-universe platform-launch eras) — the two had been used interchangeably since Film 1's header, which is exactly what made THE FRAME (Film 5, Release Phase 1, but a Story-Phase-2-dated story) read as a contradiction. Added the distinction to §9's intro and every row of its table, and updated every script's title header (<code>scripts/THE_ROSTER.md</code> through <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code>) to say "Release Phase 1" explicitly. No dates, founders, or platform assignments changed — this is a labeling fix only.	User correction: "The FRAME is actually in phase 1. It's the fifth film of phase 1"
2026-09-18	Locked Emma and Victoria Bullock's conception date at approximately September 15, 2011, using realistic twin-gestation dating (36-week average GA, not a full-term 40 weeks) back from their locked May 10, 2012 birth. Ties directly to <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code> scene 32, now dated September 2011 explicitly. Added the full pregnancy timeline to <code>TSU_Family_Bible.md</code> 's Victoria Bullock entry.	User question: "When would Esther Smilley be pregnant with the twins... make it realistic to real life pregnancies"
2026-09-18	Locked Film 7: THE ROSTER 3: THE UNSEEN ("Iron Man 3" slot), opening Release Phase 2. No new platform; a third THE ROSTER film, closing on the fixed May 10, 2012 twin-birth date. Activated Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist's promised resurfacing in <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code> as the Aldrich Killian analog. Esther Smilley formally named THE ROSTER's President in-story. Added §9 Release Phase 2 note and a post-Film-7 §4 checkpoint.	Script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_ROSTER_3.md</code>)

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Clarified §4's post-Film-7 checkpoint: Marc-Anthony remains Chairman and CEO of THE ROSTER, unchanged; Esther's new title is President over day-to-day operations specifically, not a change to his role.	User correction
2026-09-18	Overridden: Film 8 is THE PROJECTOR 2, not a second THE FRAME. Removed the original <code>scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md</code> draft and reverted its canon edits (Celeste Marlowe's second return, Delphine's second backing, Walter Cummings's death). Locked Film 8 as THE PROJECTOR 2: THE LULLABY ("Thor: The Dark World" slot), Release Phase 2 Film 2. No new platform; a second THE PROJECTOR film. Added Vernon Price to <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code> (the Malekith analog, unstated backstory since THE PROJECTOR's "creator-first launch" made a name); activated Marcus Nguyen-Brandt's first on-screen use there instead; noted Maxwell Sterling Asante's second backing. Locked Coralee Avery's death (July 2013, stroke) in <code>TSU_Family_Bible.md</code> as the Frigga analog, replacing Walter Cummings. Finally dramatized the Marc-Anthony/Esther wedding and Amond/Harmony's "together 2013" beat, both locked since the franchise's earliest canon and never yet staged on-screen — updated the locked romantic timeline in §4 accordingly. Added a post-Film-8 §4 checkpoint.	User correction/override: "second The Projector movie," not THE FRAME 2 — script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md</code>)

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 9: THE FRAME 2: THE VERDICT ("Captain America: The Winter Soldier" slot), Release Phase 2 Film 3 — this title now correctly refers to Arianna Cummings's actual second film, distinct from the discarded Film 8 draft above. Arianna Cummings and Marc-Anthony Bullock co-lead. Escalated Evelyn Marchetti-Hale into the franchise's most dangerous villain yet in <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code> (Alexander Pierce analog); fully activated Jules Abernathy-Kim (Sam Wilson position) and Benji Oyelaran-Cox (Bucky Barnes position, not prosecuted once exposed); played Priya Ramasubramanian's Nick Fury fake-death trick straight, revealed alive at the climax. Named but did not yet stage Chioma Asante-Reyes in the stinger, years ahead of her locked Phase 4 arrival. Added a post-Film-9 §4 checkpoint.	Script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md</code>)

Doc status: Living document. This is the canon authority — if another doc ever conflicts with this one, this one wins until a change is logged in §8.

9. FILM RELEASE ORDER — MCU-SLOT MAPPING

Tracks which TSU film fills which MCU-analog release slot — a separate axis from the in-universe story Phase timeline in §3. **These are two different meanings of the word "Phase" and they are not interchangeable:**

- **Release Phase** (this section): a grouping of *films*, mirroring how the MCU's own Phase 1 was a slate of six releases. **TSU's Release Phase 1 is Films 1 through 6 — THE ROSTER, THE WIRE, THE ROSTER 2, THE PROJECTOR, THE FRAME, and THE ASSEMBLY — full stop, regardless of what year each film's story is set in. Release Phase 2 opens at Film 7 (THE ROSTER 3), mirroring the MCU's own six-film Phase 2 slate (Iron Man 3, Thor: The Dark World, Captain America: The Winter Soldier, Guardians of the Galaxy, Avengers: Age of Ultron, Ant-Man).**
- **Story Phase** (§3): a grouping of *platform launch dates* inside the fictional timeline — Story Phase 1 is "The Founding Four," 2002–2004 only.

A film's Release Phase and its story's Story Phase do not have to match, and mostly don't: exactly as *Captain America: The First Avenger* is a Release Phase 1 film set in the 1940s, decades before *Iron Man*'s present-day Release Phase 1 story, THE FRAME (Film 5) is a **Release Phase 1** film whose story happens to fall inside **Story Phase 2** (2005–2010) on the in-universe platform-launch timeline. Both things are true at once and neither overrides the other. When in doubt, "Phase 1" on its own (as in "the fifth film of Phase 1") means Release Phase 1 — the film slate — unless a script or doc explicitly says "Story Phase" or cites §3.

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 1	Iron Man	THE ROSTER	Marc-Anthony Bullock (founder), Amond Baker (co-founder, diluted out)	Sept 2003 – Feb 4, 2004 (Story Phase 1)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ROSTER.md
Film 2	The Incredible Hulk	THE WIRE	Amond Baker (sole founder)	March 2005 – March 21, 2006, launch fixed per §3 (Story Phase 2)	Locked — see scripts/THE_WIRE.md
Film 3	Iron Man 2	THE ROSTER (again — dramatizes the opening act of the "Feed War" anchor, §3)	Marc-Anthony Bullock, solo (Amond absent — concurrent with his isolation period at the start of Film 2)	April 2004 – Jan 5, 2005 (Story Phase 1)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md
Film 4	Thor	THE PROJECTOR	Tyrese Avery, solo	April 2005 – Dec 2005, launch anchor 2005 per §3 (Story Phase 2)	Locked — see scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.m

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 5	Captain America: The First Avenger	THE FRAME	Arianna Cummings, solo	Jan 2009 – Oct 25, 2010, launch anchor 2010 per §3 (Story Phase 2 — see the Release/Story Phase note above; this film is Release Phase 1 regardless)	Locked — see scripts/THE_FRAME.md
Film 6	The Avengers (Release Phase 1 finale / ensemble crossover)	No new platform — THE EVERYTHING (new, Cassius Wren) as the threat; dramatizes the Feed War's off-screen resolution and the Quiet Acquisition anchor	Marc-Anthony Bullock, Amond Baker, Tyrese Avery, Arianna Cummings, all four together, with Esther Smilley, Harmony Divine, and Tyler Chapman in load-bearing supporting roles	Jan 2011 – Nov 2011 (Story Phase 3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md Closes Release Phase 1 (Films 1–6).
Film 7	Iron Man 3 (Release Phase 2, Film 1)	THE ROSTER, a third time — no new founding story	Marc-Anthony Bullock (lead), Esther Smilley (full co-lead, her own hero beat), Amond Baker, Tyrese Avery, and Arianna Cummings in coordinated ensemble support	Jan 5, 2012 – May 10, 2012 (Story Phase 3; closes on the fixed, locked twin-birth date)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ROSTER_3.md Opens Release Phase 2.

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 8	Thor: The Dark World (Release Phase 2, Film 2)	THE PROJECTOR, a second time — no new founding story	Tyrese Avery, Jamal Kester, and Dr. Simone Kester (leads); Marc-Anthony/Esther and Amond/Harmony's locked relationship beats dramatized on-screen for the first time as ensemble support	Feb 2013 – Aug 2013 (Story Phase 3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2
Film 9	Captain America: The Winter Soldier (Release Phase 2, Film 3)	THE FRAME, a second time — no new founding story; the threat sits in shared infrastructure across THE ROSTER, THE FRAME, and other platforms	Arianna Cummings and Marc-Anthony Bullock co-lead; Jules Abernathy-Kim and Benji Oyelaran-Cox fully activated; Priya Ramasubramanian in the Nick Fury position	Jan 2014 – June 2014 (Story Phase 3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md

Note on Film 3: dramatizes only the *opening* of the Feed War (TOP8 wounded, not finished) — the full ensemble payoff of that anchor is deliberately reserved for a later Phase 1 finale film, per house style §2's separate "Phase finale / ensemble crossover" spec, which Film 3 does not use. Film 3 also runs concurrent with the first few weeks of Film 2 (Amond is already isolating in Atlanta throughout Film 3 and does not appear onscreen in it).

Why a second THE FRAME for Film 9 (Winter Soldier slot): Winter Soldier is about discovering the institution you trusted has been corrupted from within since before you joined it, and a friend presumed lost turning out to be a weapon someone else built. THE ROSTER absorbed THE FRAME in good faith in [scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md](#) — exactly the kind of institutional trust this film tests. Evelyn Marchetti-Hale's bible entry always specified "right roughly half the time" — this film dramatizes the other half at real scale, rather than inventing a new villain from nothing. Benji Oyelaran-Cox's bible entry always specified they'd "age up across the whole timeline" and become "quietly indispensable" — the Bucky Barnes slot needed exactly a presumed-vanished character everyone assumed had simply moved on, and Benji was already built for it. Priya Ramasubramanian, the franchise's connective tissue since Film 1, finally gets the Nick Fury trick played on her own arc rather than just the corkboard function.

Why a second THE PROJECTOR for Film 8 (Thor: The Dark World slot): The Dark World's shape is grief arriving mid-stability, an old ideology nobody actually killed the first time, an uneasy alliance with a trickster figure, and a throne turned down for something truer. Vernon Price existed as unstated backstory the moment `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md` established a "creator-first launch" that had to be pushing something worse out of the way — he was always built to return once given a name. Marcus Nguyen-Brandt's bible entry always specified "offered to different founders at different low points" and had never yet been cashed in — he's the cleanest available Loki on the roster, and Tyrese Avery, four years past his own humbling, is stable enough now to be offered an actual throne (the Family-Safe Content Consortium chair) worth turning down. This film is also the natural place to finally dramatize two locked-since-the-start beats that had been sitting unstaged for the entire franchise: the Marc-Anthony/Esther wedding and the Amond/Harmony "together 2013" moment, both due in exactly this year per §4's locked romantic timeline.

Why a third THE ROSTER for Film 7 (Release Phase 2 opener): Iron Man 3 opens on a hero surviving the aftermath of a giant public battle, not building anything new — panic attacks, obsessive over-building, a past dismissal arriving to collect. Marc-Anthony is the only core-seven founder with an existing multi-film arc (Films 1 and 3) and a standing health-scare thread (the arrhythmia from Film 3) built to escalate under exactly this kind of stress. Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist's bible entry already called for a resurfacing "in later Phases" as a scorned-but-brilliant consultant — the Aldrich Killian slot needs exactly that shape of villain, someone with a real grievance rather than a cartoon one. Esther Smiley, now locked as running THE ROSTER's operations day to day, gets the Pepper-Potts-Extremis beat: not rescued, self-rescuing, on her own terms, seven months pregnant.

Why THE ASSEMBLY (no new platform) for Film 6: the Avengers doesn't introduce a new hero's origin — it forces the ones already introduced into the same room against a threat none of them can survive alone. TSU already had the pieces built and waiting: Priya Ramasubramanian's corkboard (three stingers running), Marc-Anthony and Amond's unresolved estrangement, Teddy Ashcombe-Vance's slow-burn betrayal (his bible entry always called for a reveal "across two Phases"), and the Platform Roster's own long-standing "Open Slots to Discuss" note asking for a Google+ analog "that sounds like hubris." THE EVERYTHING (Cassius Wren, new) fills that last slot as the villain rather than a hero, and its collapse gives TSU's fractured, competing ecosystem its clearest possible thematic statement: many platforms coexisting is the correct outcome, not an unsolved problem.

Why THE FRAME for Film 5: THE FRAME was flagged as reserved for the Captain America slot back when THE PROJECTOR was locked (Film 4), because it already carried that framing in the Platform Roster before any release-slot planning began. Arianna Cummings is the only remaining core-seven member whose origin wound was locked as *mandatory to dramatize* (§4) — a person told, repeatedly, by every gatekeeper that she lacks the superficial thing they're measuring, until someone finally sees what's real underneath. This film deliberately does not repeat the co-founder-betrayal structure used twice already (Films 1 and, by extension, 2) — Cap's antagonist is external, not a best friend, so Malcolm Pierce fills the Peggy Carter position (a new, unlocked relationship, same pattern as Tyrese/Simone) rather than a co-founder role, and Desmond Cummings Jr. (already locked as a firefighter in the Family Bible) fills the Bucky position without requiring any retcon.

Why THE PROJECTOR for Film 4: Tyrese Avery is the only core-seven member already famous on his own axis before Phase 1 even opens, and his Core Cast bio never locked a romantic partner the way the other six did — both facts made him the cleanest available Thor: inherited greatness, an arrogance that

costs him everything, banishment to an ordinary world, and a new relationship (Dr. Simone Kester) this film originates rather than works around. Reverend Earl Avery fills the Odin position using material already on the books; Jeri Avery deliberately stays loyal throughout rather than becoming a Loki, preserving his locked bible entry instead of retconning it for drama.

Why THE WIRE for Film 2: Twitter/X's real cultural identity — fast, addictive, real-time, structurally incapable of nuance, capable of turning a normal person into a viral mob target before anyone can process what happened — is TSU's cleanest available "you wouldn't like me when I'm angry" analog. Amond Baker, walking away from THE ROSTER quietly furious and permanently under-credited, builds a platform meant to give people an unfiltered, unmediated voice — the opposite of being diluted and silenced — and it grows into something with real, uncontrollable power to destroy a person's reputation overnight, power even its own founder fears and can't fully leash. That's Bruce Banner's arc structurally: the guarded, controlled one builds (releases) something out of his own wound that becomes bigger, angrier, and more dangerous than he intended. It also lets Film 2 pay off Film 1's ending directly, satisfying the Continuity Bible's 30%-serialized cross-film thread rule (§1) without requiring the audience to have seen Film 1 to follow Film 2's own self-contained story (per the 70% rule).